

CHAPTER 3: JOB ANALYSIS AND JOB DESIGN

- *Introduction to job analysis*

Organizations today are depending on their human resources. Revolutionary change, complex technologies and global competition means increasing vulnerability. Organizations that fail to have the right people in the right place at the right time are at risk.

A proper match between work and employee capabilities is now an economic necessity (*but how do you ensure a match between work & employee capabilities?.Role of job analysis*)

Definition

Job analysis is a basic HR activity which focuses attention on what employees are expected to do.

Job analysis is defined *as the process by which jobs are divided to determine what tasks, duties and responsibilities they include their relationship to other jobs, the conditions under which work is performed, and the personal capabilities required for satisfactory performance.*

Larger organizations usually have HR specialists called **job analysts** who undertake this systematic collection, evaluation and organization of job information. Smaller organizations usually make the task part of the HR manager's job portfolio.

Purpose of job analysis

The purpose of job analysis is to obtain answers to the following questions:-

- Why does the job exist?
- What physical and mental activities do the worker undertakes?
- When is the job to be performed?
- Where is the job to be performed?
- How does the worker do the job?
- What qualifications are needed to perform the job?
- What gets done?
- How is it done?
- Skills required?
- What are the working conditions (such as the levels of temperature, light, offensive fumes and noise) of the job?
- What machinery or equipment is used in the job?
- What constitutes successful performance?

Group Assignment 1: Visit any organization, identify any office of your choice and collect data on these questions above. Link this information to HRP recruitment, selection, training, appraisal and compensation. You will be required to present the findings from the field to the class

Uses of Job Analysis

The information produced by job analysis is used extensively in HRM.

It is difficult to imagine how an organization could effectively hire, train, appraise, compensate or use its human resources without the kinds of information derived from job analysis.

The uses include the following:

- ***Job descriptions*** define what a job is by identifying its content, requirements and context. Providing a written summary of the duties and responsibilities of the job, job descriptions help managers and current and prospective employees to understand what the job is to be performed.

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- ***Job specifications*** focus on the personal characteristics and qualifications that an employee must possess to perform the job successfully.
- ***Job design*** identifies what work must be performed, how it will be performed, where it is to be performed and who will perform it. Job analysis information is invaluable in determining which tasks should be grouped together to form a job, and for structuring jobs, so that employee satisfaction and performance can be enhanced.

Job analysis assumes that jobs already exist.

Job design is the process of designing the way work will be performed and the tasks that will be required in a particular job.

Job redesign is the process of changing the tasks or the way work is done in an existing job.

To effectively design jobs, one must understand the job as it exists (through job analysis) and its place in the larger work unit's work flow process (work-flow analysis).

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- Job analysis information can help identify and clarify the ***organizational structure and design*** by clarifying job requirements and the interrelationship among job, job content, by minimizing overlap or duplication.
- ***HR planning*** involves getting the right number of qualified people into the right job at the right time. Job analysis information is essential for HR planning because it helps to accurately determine the number and types of employees to be recruited or exited from the organisation

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- Job analysis information aids the ***recruitment process*** by establishing the job requirement to be met and thus identifying who to recruit (and how and where to recruit them), helping the HR manager to attract better qualified candidates. In addition, job analysis identifies irrelevant and / or distorted job information, thus permitting the HR manager to provide realistic job previews.
- Job analysis information assists the ***selection process*** by identifying what the job is by defining its duties and responsibilities. This facilitates the development of job related selection techniques, helps ensure that EEO (equal employer opportunity) requirements are met and increases the likelihood of a proper matching of an applicant with the job.

N.B: Equal employer opportunity (EEO) “*An employer that pledges to not discriminate against employees based on race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability or genetic information.*”

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- ***Effective job orientation*** requires a clear understanding of the work to be performed, which is exactly what job analysis provides. A new employee cannot be properly taught how to do job if duties and responsibilities are not clearly defined.
- Job analysis information is essential to the establishment of ***performance standards and performance appraisal***. It provides a thorough understanding of what the employee is supposed to do. Without this information, acceptable levels of performance cannot be determined and an accurate measure of actual performance cannot be obtained.

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- Job analysis information is used to ***design and implement training and development programs***. The job specification defines the knowledge, skills and abilities required for successful job performance. This allows the HR manager to establish training and development objectives, design programs and determine whether a current or potential employee require training.
- HR managers are better placed to offer ***career planning and development guidance*** when they have a good understanding of the types of jobs existing in an organization. Similarly, by identifying jobs and requirements, employees become aware of their career options and what constitutes a realistic career objective for them in the organization.

Individual assignment 1

Research and present on the following

- 1) Job specification
- 2) Job enlargement
- 3) Job enrichment
- 4) Techniques of job analysis
- 5) Job design approaches. Also advantages and disadvantages of each approach
- 6) The benefits of Human Resource Planning
- 7) limitations for Human Resource Planning